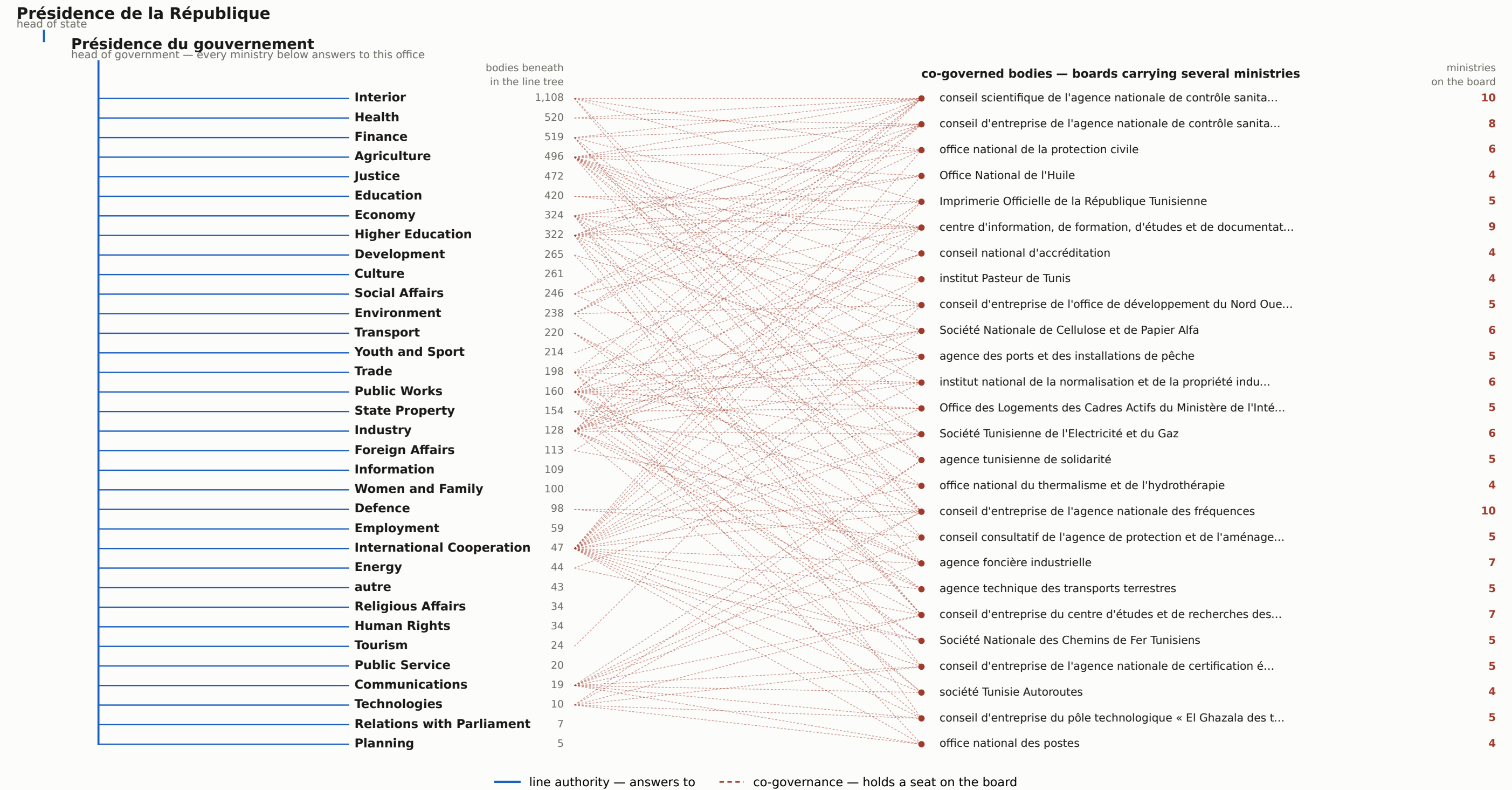


The ministries answer to the head of government; the companies answer to several ministries at once

Solid lines are line authority: the head of state, the head of government beneath him, the 34 ministries beneath that, and the count of bodies under each. Dashed lines are a different relation — a ministry holding a seat on a body's board, written in the gazette as “membre représentant le ministère de ...”. That relation is many-to-many and no tree will hold it: of 226 bodies governed this way, 121 (54%) have more than one ministry on the board, and the 26 drawn here are those with at least 3. The Société tunisienne de l'électricité et du gaz carries six ministries, the Agence Nationale des Fréquences ten. The crossing in the middle of the plate is the point: economic governance in this state does not run down the chain of command, it runs across it.



Source: Journal Officiel de la République Tunisienne, 1957–2026 (6,378 French issues, jort.tn). Author's extraction. Two relations, two sources. The dashed edges are read from appointments: where the gazette records a board seat as 'membre représentant le ministère de X', that ministry is taking part in the body's governance; seats recorded as 'représentant l'État' are held for the state at large and carry no edge, which is why 1,536 of the 3,023 representation appointments are not drawn. The solid edges below the ministries are reconstructed from the register — neither the organisations table nor the gazette carries a parent field, and the parent recorded on a spell belongs to the act rather than the body, one body carrying 89 different parents that way — so attachment is read from a body's own name first, the commonest parent its acts give it second, its portfolio third. The solid edges above the ministries are not read off the data at all: the gazette records appointments, not the constitution, and the ordering of head of state, head of government and ministries is imposed. It is marked constitutional in the table so it can be filtered out. That ordering also moved over the period — the 1959 constitution put the prime minister well below a dominant president, 2014 made the office genuinely semi-presidential, 2022 reduced it again, and under the 2014 settlement defence and foreign affairs answered to the President directly rather than through the head of government. A union chart cannot draw a relationship that changed three times, so it draws the ordering that held throughout. Bodies are ordered by the average position of the ministries governing them, which minimises crossing; what crosses anyway is structure and not layout. An explorable version carries every one of the 8,803 bodies in the line tree.